

Incident Management Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Requirement Analysis, Planning & Execution Document

Phase 1: Requirement Analysis & Planning

Business Objectives

The objective of this project is to automate and standardize the Incident Management lifecycle using ServiceNow's Incident module.

Key goals include:

- Enable Service Desk agents to create and classify incidents.
- Integrate Knowledge Management for faster resolution.
- Allow reassignment to appropriate support groups.
- Enable Level 2 technicians to investigate and resolve incidents.
- Create emergency change requests directly from incidents. • Allow child incident creation for tracking recurring issues.
- Generate knowledge articles from resolved incidents.
- Improve SLA compliance and service visibility.

Functional Scope

- Incident Record Creation in Service Operations Workspace.
- Incident Classification (Category, Subcategory, Urgency, Service, CI).
- Agent Assist Knowledge Integration.
- Reassignment to Level 2 Support Teams.
- Emergency Change Request Creation.
- Child Incident Creation.
- Incident Cause & Resolution Documentation.
- Knowledge Article Creation from Incident.
- SLA and Related Record Tracking.

Stakeholder Mapping

Stakeholder	Role	Needs / Expectations	Impact of Automation
End Users	Report IT issues	Quick resolution, visibility	Faster issue resolution; transparent tracking

Service Desk Agents	First-level support	Easy logging, classification tools	Standardized intake; faster escalation
Stakeholder	Role	Needs / Expectations	Impact of Automation
Level 2 Support (Network/Hardware Teams)	Diagnose & resolve issues	Complete incident data, related records	Better diagnosis; clear task ownership
Change Management Team	Handle emergency changes	Structured change requests	Integrated change control
ServiceNow Admin	Maintain configuration	Scalable and trackable solution	Controlled process management

Execution Roadmap

Milestones:

- Incident Record Creation
- Incident Classification
- Knowledge Integration
- Reassignment & Escalation
- Change Request Creation
- Child Incident Creation
- Incident Resolution
- Knowledge Creation
- SLA & Related Record Validation

Skills:

- Incident Management
- Agent Assist
- Change Management Integration
- Related Lists
- SLAs
- Knowledge Management

Phase 2: Create New Service, Service Offering

If you have admin access, create the service.

Milestone 1: Create New Service

Steps to Create New Service:

1. Go to All.
2. Search → cmdb_ci_service.LIST.
3. Click New.
4. Fill details:
 - Name: Remote Access
 - Operational status: Operational
5. Click Submit.

dev407282.service-now.com/cmdb_ci_service.do?sys_id=-1&sys_is_list=true&sys_target=cmdb_ci_service&sysparm_checked_items=&sysparm_fixed_query=&sysparm_group_sort=&sysp...

Service New record

Submit

Name	Remote Access	Approval group	
Model ID		Support group	
Owned by		Change Group	
Business criticality	2 - somewhat critical	Managed by	
Version		SLA	
Used for	Production	Location	
Operational status	Operational	Vendor	
Service classification	Business Service		
Comments			

Submit

Related Links

- [Convert to business service](#)
- [Convert to technology management service](#)

Milestone 2: Create New Service Offering If

you have admin access, create the service.

Steps to Create New Service Offering:

1. Go to All.
2. Search → service_offering.LIST.
3. Click New.
4. Fill details:
 - Name: Corporate VPN
 - Parent: Remote Access • Operational status: Operational
5. Click Submit.

dev407282.service-now.com/service_offering.do?sys_id=2b51810383c74310815ee360ceaad38f&sysparm_record_target=service_offering&sysparm_record_row=1&sysparm_record_rows=...

Offering Corporate VPN

Name: Corporate VPN

Model ID: [Search]

Owned by: [Search]

* Parent: Remote Access [Search]

Used for: Production

Operational status: Operational

Vendor: [Search]

Approval group: [Search]

Support group: [Search]

Change group: [Search]

Managed by: [Search]

Version: [Search]

Business criticality: 2 - somewhat critical

SLA: [Search]

Location: [Search]

Short Description: [Text Area]

Description: [Text Area]

Comments: [Text Area]

Related Items: Show 3 Levels

Contract: [Search]

Phase 3: Incident Record Creation

Creating Incident Record

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Impersonate Beth Anglin.
3. Navigate to: Service Operations Workspace > List > Incidents > Open.
4. Click on New.

dev407282.service-now.com/now/sow/list/params/list-id/b16a321ac3013010965e070e9140dd3a/_state_/b64--eyllNGQ0NmFIM2ViyZQxMjEwMzg5MGRkZGUyMzUyMjhhOCi6eyJsaXN0...

Service Operations Workspace

Incidents - Open 44 Last refreshed just now.

Number	Short description	Caller	Priority	State	Service	Assignment group
INC0009005	Email server is down.	David Miller	1 - Critical	New		
INC0009001	Unable to post content on a Wiki page	David Miller	3 - Moderate	New		
INC0008112	Assessment : ATF Assessor	survey user	5 - Planning	New		
INC0008111	ATF : Test1	System Administrator	5 - Planning	New		
INC0008001	ATF:TEST2	survey user	5 - Planning	New		
INC0007002	Need access to the common drive.	David Miller	4 - Low	New		
INC0007001	Employee payroll application server is down.	David Miller	1 - Critical	New		Openspace

Showing 1-20 of 44

Records per page 20

5. Fill the details:

- Short description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office
 - Caller: Michael Hoefer
6. Click Save.

dev407282.service-now.com/now/sow/record/incident/-1_uid_1/params/query/active%3Dtrue

Service Operations Workspace

Create New Incident

Save Assign to me

Incident

Short description *

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Description

Number INC0010008 State New

Caller * Michael Hoefer Impact 3 - Low

Location SHS quadra 5, Bloco E., Brasilia Urgency 3 - Low

Channel -- None -- Priority 5 - Planning

Agent Assist

Q Unable to connect to Corp...

Article How to configure VPN for Apple ...
How to configure VPN for Apple Devices For an iPhone or iPad running iOS? Select Sett...
updated 12 years ago - 3 views

Article Automatic Replies (Out Of Office)
Automatic Replies (Out Of Office) This article explains how to use automatic replies in...
updated 4 years ago - 85 views

Article Excel Functionality
Excel Functionality Copying formulas without changing cell locations When you want to...

7. Go to Details tab.
8. Assignment group: Service Desk.
9. Click Save.

dev407282.service-now.com/now/sow/record/incident/7c5df24b83c78310815ee360ceaad30f/params/query/active%3Dtrue/selected-tab-index/1/selected-tab/id%3Dd1kajg2y015e3f71kyb7f5qr

Service Operations Workspace

Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Save Create change request Assign to me Resolve

Overview Details Related records

Impact

Business impact

Assignment

Assignment group Service Desk Assigned to

Related Records

Parent Incident Change Request

Problem Caused by Change

Work notes Comments Email Stacked view

Everyone can see this comment

Activity

Beth Anglin
Field changes • 2026-09-05 06:51:33

Impact 3 - Low
Incident state New
Opened by Beth Anglin
Priority 5 - Planning

Record Information

Last updated by Beth Anglin
2026-09-05 06:51:33

Caller Michael Hoefer
Development
Brasilia - 06:51:37
America/Los_Angeles

Contact

Recent incidents >
Recent interactions >
Assigned assets >

Assigned to

This incident has not been assigned yet

Phase 4: Incident Classification

Updating Incident Details

Incident classification involves categorizing incidents based on their type, category, subcategory, impact, and urgency. This ensures accurate prioritization, proper assignment, and faster resolution while improving reporting and service management efficiency.

Stay in the same incident.

Go to the Details tab.

Update the following:

- Description: Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.
- Channel: Phone
- Category: Network
- Subcategory: VPN
- Urgency: 2 - Medium
- Service: Remote Access
- Service Offering: Corporate VPN
- Configuration Item: ThinkStationS20(Any one)
- In Compose Section >> Work notes: Classified and assigned incident.
- Click **Assign to me**
- Save.

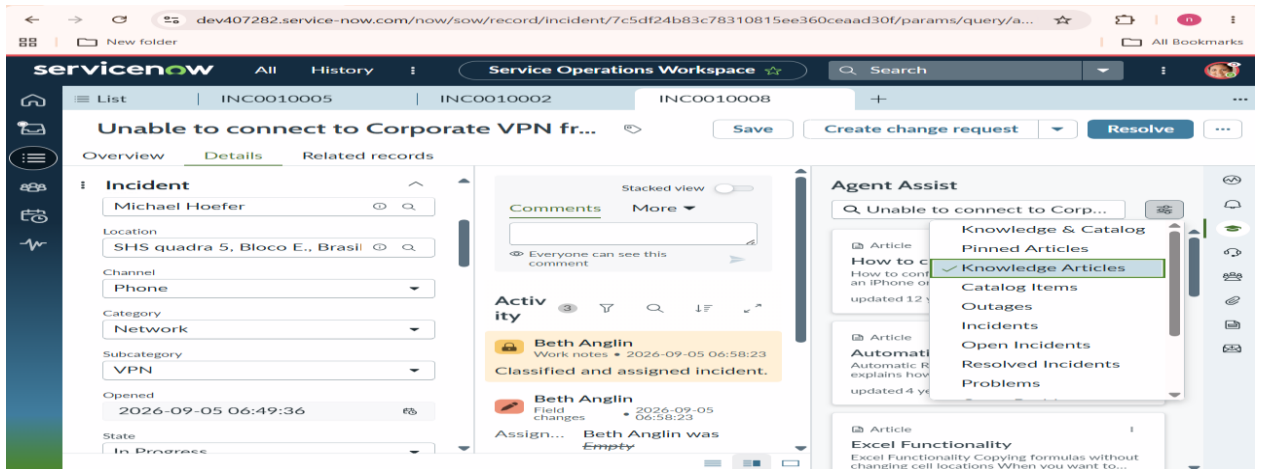
The screenshot shows the ServiceNow incident record interface for the incident 'Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office' (INC0010008). The interface is divided into several sections:

- Incident Details:** Includes fields for Location (SHS quadra 5, Bloco E., Bra:), Urgency (2 - Medium), Priority (4 - Low), Channel (Phone), Category (Network), Subcategory (VPN), and Opened date (2026-09-05 06:49:36).
- Compose:** A section for adding work notes and comments. The work notes field contains the text 'Classified and assigned incident,'. The comments field is empty. The email field shows 'To: Michael Hoefer' and 'Cc: Beth Anglin'.
- Record Information:** Shows the caller as Michael Hoefer (Development, Brasilia - 06:52:52, America/Los_Angeles) and the last updated by as Beth Anglin (2026-09-05 06:52:49).
- SLAs and timings:** Shows the Response SLA as 6d 5h and the Resolution SLA as No matching SLA.

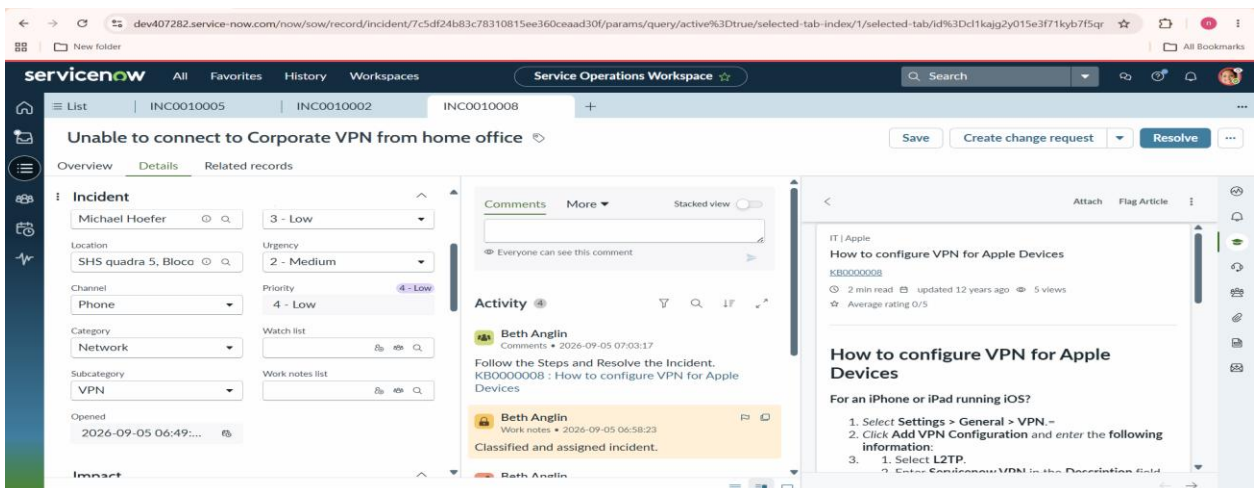
Phase 5: Knowledge Integration

Agent Assist Verification

1. Click Agent Assist on the right side panel.
2. Ensure Knowledge Articles are selected.



3. Verify knowledge articles appear based on short descriptions.
4. Open any one of the articles.
5. Click on the 3 dots and Mark Article as Helpful.
6. Click Attach Article.
7. Give Comment: Follow the Steps and Resolve the Incident.
8. Select Attach Article.
9. Return to incident.
10. Verify:
 - Knowledge article linked in Activity log
 - Helpful indicator marked

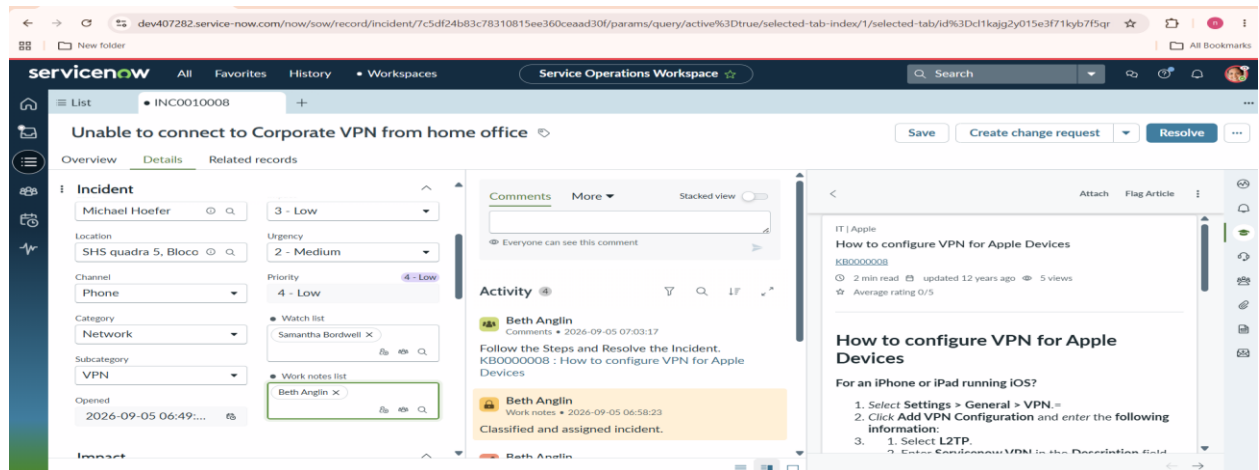


Phase 6: Reassignment & Escalation

Watch List Update

In the Details tab:

- Add Samantha Bordwell to the Watch list so she can track the incident and receive updates.
- Add Beth Anglin to the Work notes list so she can follow the work notes and stay updated on the incident resolution.

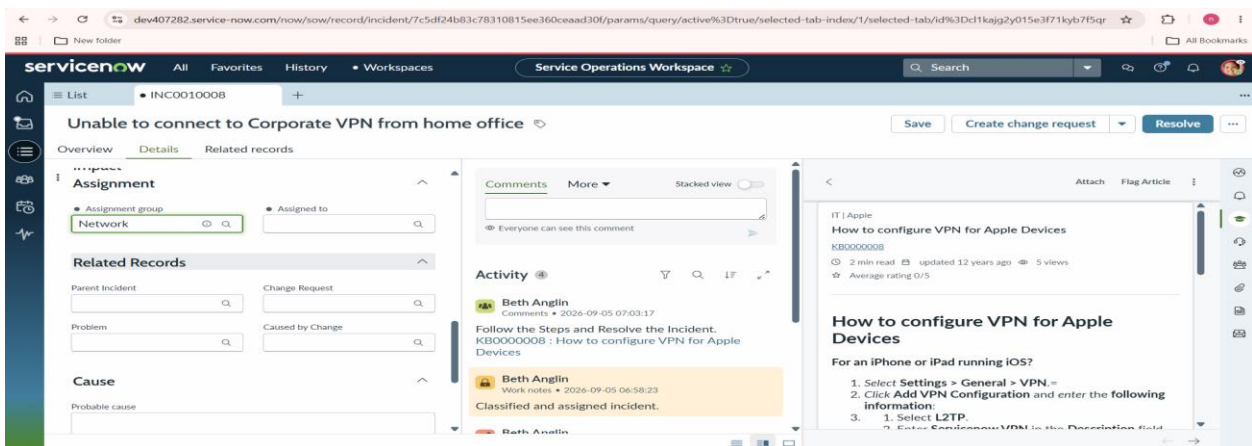


This allows the incident to be assigned to another team for further resolution and tracking, while ensuring the required members can monitor the incident and its updates.

***Note:** If any of the mentioned members cannot be found, select another available member instead.*

Reassignment

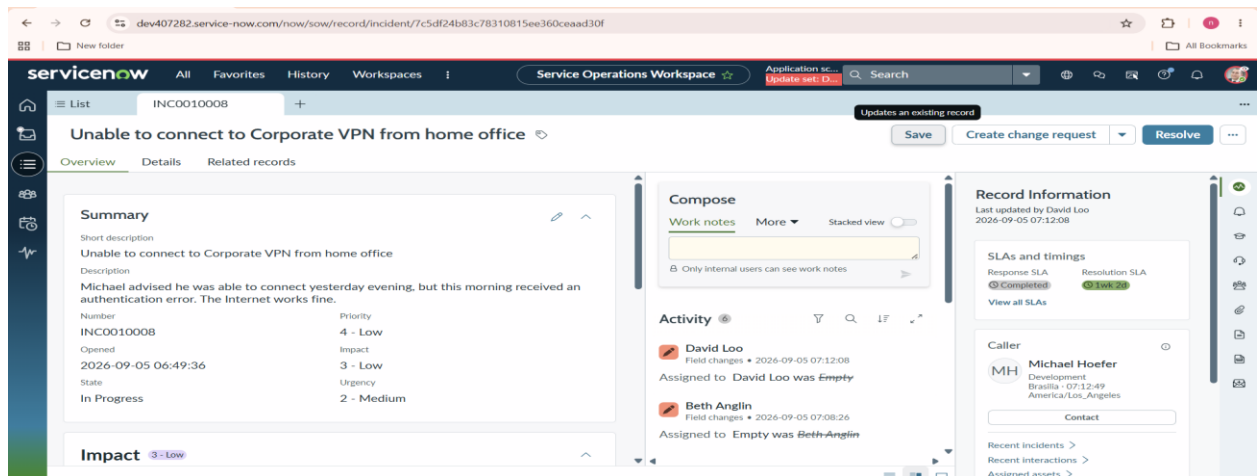
1. Update Assignment group to: Network.
2. Verify Assigned to field clears automatically.
3. Click Save.



Phase 7: Incident Tracking by Level 2

Investigation by Network Team

1. Impersonate David Loo.
2. Select the 3 dots on the banner, select Workspaces, and navigate to: Service Operations Workspace >> Incidents >> Open.
3. Open the VPN incident.
4. Click Assign to me.
5. Verify:
 - Description visible
 - Knowledge articles visible
 - SLA visible in Task SLAs in Related Records section



Phase 8: Emergency Change Request Creation

Create Change

1. Update Configuration Item from ThickStation to PowerEdge.
2. Save.
3. Return to incident.
4. Update:
 - State: On Hold
 - On Hold Reason: Awaiting Change
5. Save.

The screenshot shows a ServiceNow incident record for the title "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office". The incident number is INC0010008. The state is "On Hold" with the reason "Awaiting Change". The caller is Michael Hoefer. The location is SHS quadra 5, Bloco E., Brasilia. The description states: "Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine." The activity log shows updates from David Loo and Beth Anglin regarding field changes and assignments.

Phase 9: Child Incident Creation

Create Child Incident

1. From Related Records tab → Select Child Incidents >> New.
2. Short Description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN.
3. Caller: Select any user.
4. Description: User receiving VPN authentication failure error.
5. Save.

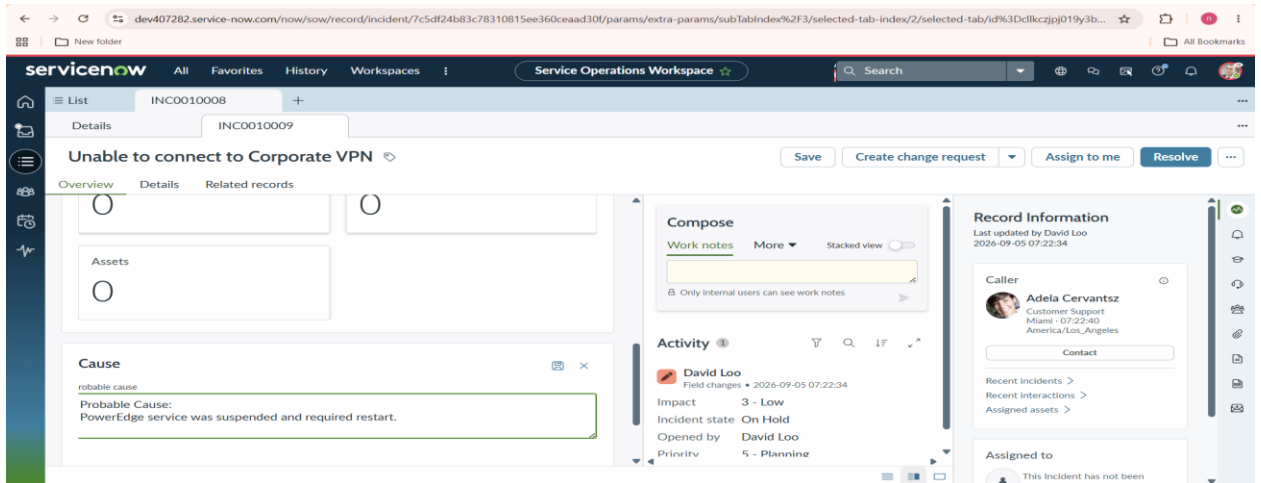
The screenshot shows the "Create New Incident" form. The short description is "Unable to connect to Corporate VPN". The description is "User receiving VPN authentication failure error". The incident number is INC0010009. The state is "New". The caller is Adela Cervantsz. The location is 8306 Mills Drive, Miami, FL. The impact is "3 - Low" and the urgency is "3 - Low". The priority is "Low". An "Agent Assist" sidebar on the right shows a search for "Unable to connect to Corp..." and a result for "Eclipse configuration for Android d...".

6. Make note of the incident number.
7. Return to parent incident >> Related Records.
8. Verify child incident listed.

Phase 10: Incident Resolution

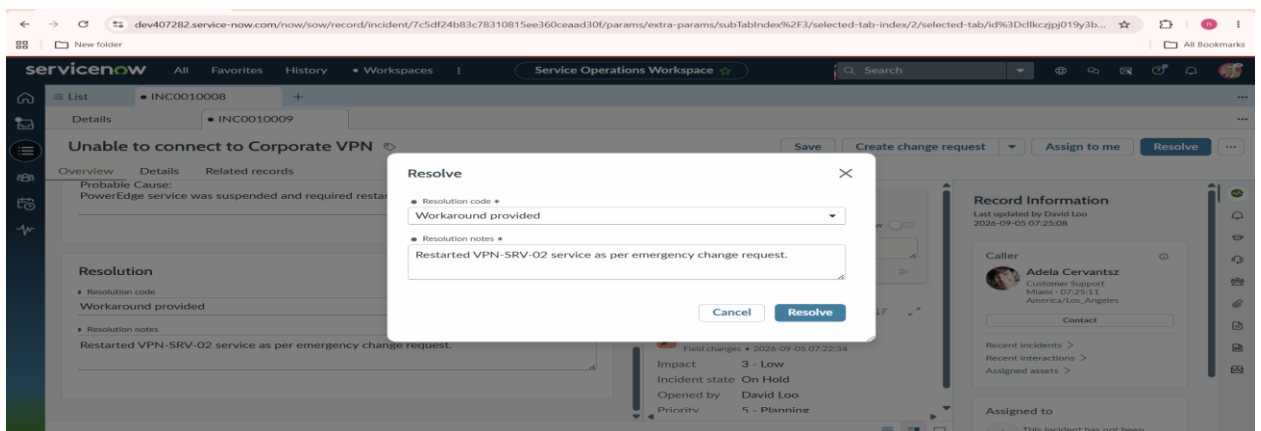
Add Cause

1. On the Overview tab → Add Cause.
2. Probable Cause: PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.
3. Save.



Add Resolution

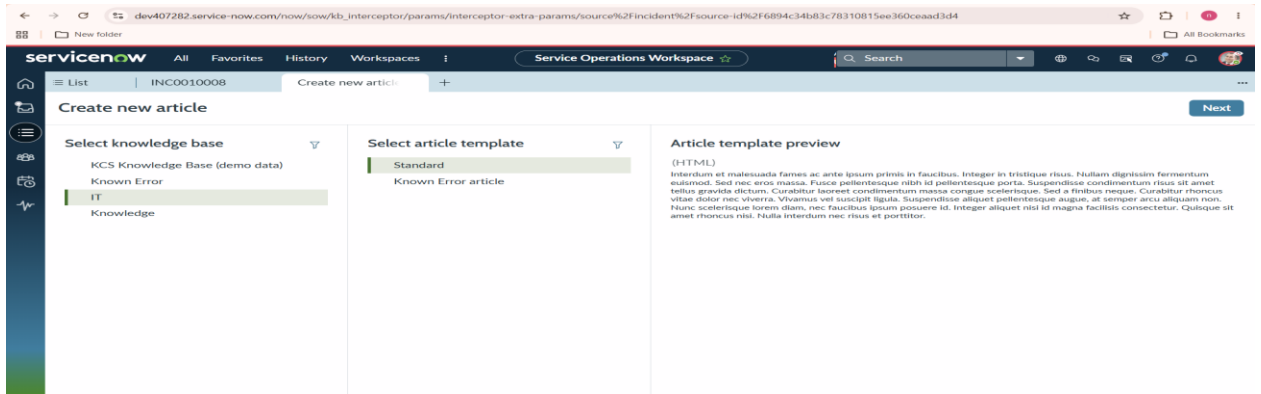
1. Add Resolution.
2. Resolution Code: Workaround provided.
3. Resolution Notes: Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.
4. Save resolution.
5. Click Resolve.
6. Confirm popup → Resolve.



Phase 11: Knowledge Creation

Create Knowledge Article

1. Click Create Knowledge.
2. Select IT as Knowledge Base.
3. Select article Template as Standard >> Next.



4. Verify all the Details >> Save.
5. Go back to Parent Record.
6. Open Related Records → Verify Created Knowledge.

Phase 12: Final Validation

Final Validation Verify:

- Parent incident state = Resolved
- Child incident state = Resolved
- Activity shows resolution triggered by parent
- Change request linked
- Knowledge article created
- SLA tracking visible

Phase 13: Testing & Deployment Validation

Testing & Deployment

This scenario validates:

- Incident lifecycle end-to-end
- Escalation process
- Change integration
- Knowledge creation

- Child incident management
- SLA tracking
- Multi-team collaboration

Phase 14: Conclusion

This project demonstrates a complete Incident Management lifecycle automation in ServiceNow.

Service Desk agents can log and classify incidents, leverage knowledge for faster resolution, escalate to Level 2 teams, initiate emergency changes, and document final resolution properly.

The integration between Incident, Change, and Knowledge modules ensures structured issue management, improved SLA adherence, and better IT service delivery.